

SERGIO A. RIVERA

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PROFILE

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics (University of Maryland) specializing in Labor, Firm Dynamics, Productivity, and Financial Frictions. Combines rigorous structural modeling with advanced computational expertise (Stata, Python, SAS) to analyze large-scale administrative microdata. Over 10 years of experience producing high-stakes quantitative research for the World Bank and the Central Bank of Colombia. Expert in building reproducible data pipelines for complex empirical analysis.

EDUCATION

Economics Ph.D. Candidate	2022 - on
Master in Economics	2025
University of Maryland	
M.Sc. in Economics, <i>Magna Cum Laude</i>	2016 - 2018
B.A. in Economics	2011 - 2015
Universidad del Rosario	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software	STATA, Python, Matlab, SAS, Excel, Eviews, R, L ^A T _E X.
Quant	Advanced Impact Evaluation Methods. DSGE heterogeneous agent models.
Languages	English, Spanish (Native).

EXPERIENCE

Senior GA	2026-on
University of Maryland. Smith School of Business	
Consultant STC	2021 -2022
World Bank Group. Poverty and Equity Department	& Summer 2023
Applied advanced econometric methods to dissect the income gender gap in Haiti and multiple West African countries, uncovering key links to economic activity, informality, and household characteristics.	
World Bank Group. Gender Group	2019 - 2021
- Led a team effort to build an algorithm to systematize the calculation of frequently used gender statistics. It is now the tool used by the team to produce the latest information on global gender gaps. - Created thousands of charts to showcase the gender gaps across and within countries, in labor, education, political participation, and other human development outcomes. - Provided evidence of the effects of forced displacement on attitudes and behaviors related to bargaining power and contraception.	
Economics Consultant	2020
Inter-American Development Bank. Vice Presidency for Countries	
Conducted impact assessments of global economic crises (e.g., 2008 financial crisis, COVID-19) on employment generation across Latin America, contributing to macroeconomic resilience strategies and forecasting models for regional economies.	
Research Assistant	Sep 2018 - Apr 2019
Claudia López, Northwestern University	
- Constructed municipality panel data with variables of state-building dimensions related to coercion, extraction, and political participation. - Modeled the effects of guerrilla demobilizations on state-building using impact evaluation methods.	

Research Assistant2016 - 2018

Universidad del Rosario, Economics Department

- Modeled the interconnections between firms in the Mexican Repo market and Mutual Funds, providing insights into financial market structure and systemic risk
- Constructed a panel data, crossing the disaggregated price indexes and the Colombian Longitudinal Survey to estimate consumer demand systems.

Research Assistant2015

Bank of the Republic of Colombia, Research Unit

- Estimated labor demand determinants using the Annual Manufacturing Survey, providing critical insights into employment trends for national macroeconomic assessments.
- Analyzed determinants of households’ demand for consumer credit, for a deeper understanding of financial stability and consumer behavior within the Colombian economy.
- Edited graphics of the book Female Unemployment in Colombia (2017) published by the alliance of IADB and the Bank of the Republic of Colombia. Under the supervision of Eduardo Lora.

ConsultantJune 2016

Jorge Florez, Economic analysis of market power in the “Diapers’ Cartel” in Colombia

- Constructed dataset for the estimation of structural demand model of differentiated products.
- Wrote the case study and conceptual framework.

PAPERS

Arango, L., & Rivera, S. A. (2022). Moderate wage increases and flexible labour contracts to protect employment in Colombian manufacturing. *Journal of Policy Modeling*, 44(3), 578-598.

ACADEMIC DISTINCTIONS

2022 - 2023	<i>Dean’s Fellow</i>	University of Maryland
2019	Master Thesis <i>magna cum laude</i>	Universidad del Rosario
2016 - 2017	Junior Researcher Fellowship	Universidad del Rosario
2011	Scholarship for B.A. in Economics	Universidad del Rosario
2017	Team Captain Econometric Game	2017 Econometric Games Amsterdam, The Netherlands
2017	Scholarship for Big Data-Co Workshop	Rosario Summer School
2014	Winner of the VI Internal Economics Academic Contest	Universidad del Rosario

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching assistant: Advanced Impact Evaluation	Summer 2017
Professors: Sergio Urzua	
Teaching assistant: Financial Economics, Applied Time Series, Econometrics	2024 - 2025
Microeconomics II (Game Theory and IO),	2017
Macroeconomics II (Economic Growth and Inflation)	
Led and Managed: Undergraduate Economics Research Group (40 students)	2016-2017

REFERENCES

Sergio Urzua (Ph.D.) Professor of Economics Department of Economics University of Maryland ☎ (1) 301-405-3266 ✉ surzua@umd.edu	John Haltiwanger (Ph.D.) Distinguished Professor of Economics Department of Economics University of Maryland ☎ (1) 301-405-3504 ✉ halt@umd.edu	Luis E. Arango (Ph.D.) Principal Senior Investigator Research Unit Banco de la República ☎ (57) 315 305 4540 ✉ larangth@banrep.gov.co
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